

Patient Education: Preparing for Care

Before an appointment

Write down your symptoms, when they started and what makes them better or worse. Bring a list of your medicines and any questions you want to ask.

During an appointment

Describe your concerns clearly, ask for explanations in plain language, and confirm the plan before leaving. Taking notes or bringing a trusted person can help you remember the details.

Preventive care

Regular check-ups can detect problems early. Common preventive steps include blood pressure checks, cholesterol and blood sugar screening as advised, recommended vaccinations and age-appropriate cancer screening discussed with a doctor.

Healthy habits

Regular activity, balanced eating, adequate sleep, not smoking, limited alcohol and stress management all support long-term health.